

7 The Bench's Mark Supreme Court Activism, 1993

"The fate of the 350-year-old Taj Mahal hangs in a delicate balance in Delhi's Supreme Court where judges fight more passionately than the Union Government," observed INDIA TODAY in February 1994. The Supreme Court joined the battle against environmental degradation when it "ordered the closure of 212 polluting industries in and around Agra," in 1993. Another incident where the judiciary was seen taking up the work of civic agencies was when it ordered the closure of the President's Estate Polo Club, saving the 86,40,000-sq m Central Ridge in the Capital that had a total encroachment of 72 per cent (INDIA TODAY July 1995).



PRASHANT PANJAB

9 Fuel for Thought CNG, 2001



VIKRAM SHARMA

"Delhi could well have the world's cleanest transport system when the entire 10,000-strong CNG-driven fleet is pressed into operation. It will be a world's first too," observed INDIA TODAY in April 2001. The Supreme Court in 1998 had moved in favour of the less polluting compressed natural gas, marking a new green era. But soon the Delhi Government found itself "battling allegations of a CNG conversion kit deal".

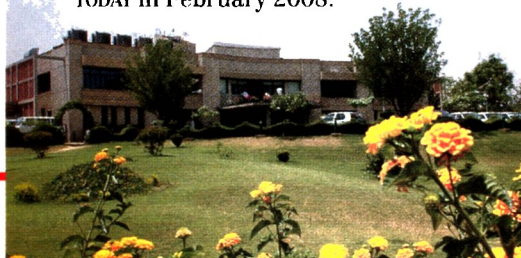
RAVI SAHANI

8 No Smoking Checking Vehicular Pollution, 1996

"For two-wheeler manufacturer Escorts Yamaha, the April 1-deadline for complying with the new auto-emission norms was no joke. While the date was fixed three years ago, most companies had assumed that it would be extended by three to six months," said INDIA TODAY in April 1996. But the Ministry of Surface Transport "paid no heed" and the norms were implemented to reduce pollution caused by two-and three-wheelers that comprised 64 per cent of the pollution in the country.

10 Green Foundation Eco-friendly Buildings, 2004

"Sustainable architecture is catching on as many organisations realise that environment-friendly architecture also makes eminent economic sense in the long run," said INDIA TODAY in October 2004. It employs concepts of energy efficiency, water conservation and the use of eco-friendly materials. It has advantages like low cost of power, less waste and easy maintenance. It is due to these reasons that the Indian Green Building Council is "targeting 1,000 Leadership in Energy and Environment-certified buildings by 2010," said INDIA TODAY in February 2008.



10

green numbers

30

tigers die in the country every year, with 60 per cent falling prey to poaching.

India Today, March 2008

Over 40,000 families have been displaced due to the Sardar Sarovar Dam project.

India Today, May 2006

95

per cent of pollution in the Ganga is due to pollutants pouring in from sewers and open drains, while only 5 per cent is because of religious rituals.

India Today, March 2008

IN 1995, A WORLD BANK STUDY SHOWED THAT INDIA LOST UP TO \$2 BILLION A YEAR DUE TO POLLUTION-LINKED HEALTH PROBLEMS, THE MOST COMMON BEING RESPIRATORY.

India Today, April 2001

2.4

per cent of the world's forests have been destroyed annually. The rate of loss is 90,000 sq km every year.

India Today, September 2002

In 2001, around 14,000 Olive Ridley turtles died along the Orissa coast, while 17,000 perished in 2000.

India Today, December 2002

4 Siberian Cranes were spotted in Palwal, near Mathura, after a period of five years.

India Today, February 2008

In 40 years, the key Himalayan glaciers have shrunk by 40 per cent.

India Today, November 2006

12

lakes in Ahmedabad remain today, compared to 125 lakes 40 years ago.

India Today, September 2001

DELHI RANKS SECOND AND KOLKATA THIRD IN THE LIST OF THE MOST POLLUTED CITIES IN THE WORLD.

India Today, August 2008